

Keeping Your Lifestyle in Check

When you achieve financial independence, you'll discover you have more choices in how you spend money and what kind of lifestyle you want for yourself and your family. We've seen that most millionaires are surprisingly frugal with their lifestyle expenses, but that doesn't mean you should hunker down, drive thirty-year-old beater cars, and never enjoy your money. At that point, you're a millionaire! It's okay to enjoy the fruit of all your hard work. You just need to do it with some wisdom and intentionality. For example, if you've got \$3 million in the bank and you've always dreamed of buying *that* \$50,000 brand-new pickup truck, go for it. It's not going to wreck your finances. Think about the cost in proportion to your wealth. A \$50,000 new car can destroy you when you're flat broke, but it's barely a blip on the radar when you've got \$3 million. But this only applies if you've paid off your house and have truly achieved financial independence. If you're not there yet, a brand-new car should be the last thing on your mind.

Financial independence gives you plenty of other amazing, new options when it comes to your lifestyle. Take Anna and Neal, for example. None of their family and friends—including their own children—has any idea of this Florida couples' net worth, but Anna and Neal are living their early retirement dream.